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travelling they are rolled up high on the thigh, and when off duty they frequently leave off the shirt and then appear only to have on a waist-cloth. Whilst at the village of Cumictien the whole male population came dressed in this fashion to look at the stranger.

The last chief of the Santa Cruz Indians was killed, together with about twenty other chiefs, by my host at San Pedro, Don Anis, about four years ago, and the said Don Anis now reigns in his stead and will continue to do so until some other chief contrives to get a party sufficiently strong to kill him in his turn.

In the village of Chunculche are several purely white people, some with fair hair. These I was informed are descendents of Spaniards who were not killed by the Indians at the time they revolted, but retained as prisoners. These people speak only the Indian language—"Maya"—and in dress and manner, and so far as I could judge, in ideas, are exactly the same as the Indians by whom they are surrounded.

Belize, British Honduras, 1*st February*, 1888.

Nilometers.

By Colonel J. C. Ardagh, C.B., R.E.

During a residence of five years in Egypt, I have from time to time made notes upon the Nile, which, though far from being complete, may prove interesting and useful to others who take up the subject, and which it may therefore be of utility to place on record.

A historical memoir of the Mekyas or Rodah nilometer is given in vol. xv. of the 'Description de l'Egypte,' by the French Expedition at the beginning of this century, and a plan and section of the Mekyas are given in vol. i. 'État Moderne,' Atlas of Plates, of the same monumental work.

Unfortunately, the reliability of this work is seriously vitiated by what are now well-established errors. The level of the Red Sea, according to the French savants, was nine or ten metres above the Mediterranean, and three or four metres above Low Nile at Cairo. How this result could have been believed, in the face of historical and visible evidences of the existence of ancient canals, is difficult to conceive.

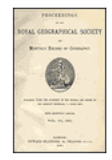
A still more remarkable conclusion, however, was their report that the Birket-el-Keroun, or Lake of the Fayoum, was the original Lake Mœris. As a matter of fact that sheet of water lies no less than 200 feet below the adjacent Nile. It is therefore necessary to receive with great caution, and not without corroboration, the statements of this work.

There were nilometers in the very earliest ages. Those at Edfou and

JOURNAL ARTICLE

Nilometers

J. C. Ardagh



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